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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

It is just before dawn, all the noise you can hear is your feet trampling the fluffy snow beneath your worn out hunting boots. The air is crisp and fresh as the first sign of daylight breaks through the aspen trees. Just when you think things couldn't seem better you hear a faint bugle in the distance. At first you don't know which way to follow because it is still quite dark out. You keep walking toward the haunting squeal of a bull elk when you come upon a clearing. As you gaze across this field of morning dew rising as the sunrays hit the soil you notice a bull elk in the distance just peeking his head out of the trees. As he reveals himself and lets out a bone chilling bugle as steam rolls out his mouth, you think to your self " Man I bet that bull has a nice pair of whistler teeth, just imagine the custom piece of jewelry Cassie could make with them!"

Cassie Leyh has been an avid hunter since she could walk. Hunting with her dad is one of her most joyous times every year. When the hunt is successful she also has the pleasure of enjoying a memory of gold and ivory forever. The best thing about creating a custom piece of jewelry around an elk tooth is that you are able to show off your skill as a hunter without hanging the head on the wall. Cassie's interest in elk and her extreme skill in jewelry making have encouraged her to follow her dreams of owning her own business. The beauty that can be revealed out of trophy bull elk's whistler teeth is astonishing. With the creativity and skill Cassie has in jewelry making you are sure to be satisfied with your one of a kind piece of artwork and keep the memories of a great hunting trip close to your heart.

Cassie Leyh is a graduate from Mesa State College with a Bachelors degree in Business Administration with concentration in management. After her studies at Mesa State she continued on to the Gemological Institute of America to become the only Certified Graduate Jeweler Gemologist in Grand Junction, Colorado. With a good business background, expertise in jewelry making, and a love for the sport of hunting, Cassie has taken the steps to fulfill her lifetime dream of owning her own business. What more could one ask for than creating special pieces of art to capture the wonderful memories of hunting.

With the hunting industry expanding every year there is potential for growth in the industry. More and more hunters want to show off their beautiful elk ivory in fashionable jewelry. The one catch that makes this jewelry so unique is that elk teeth don't just grow on trees it takes an experienced hunter and a brave bull elk for this wonderful custom piece to come together. Every hunter's dream is to take that one "Olympian bull" and tell stories about the hunt. If he/she has an elk tooth in a custom setting people will be interested to know the thrilling hunting story behind such a work of art. This is where the hunter and Cassie benefit from the piece. The hunter benefits by getting to brag about what a great hunt they had and Cassie benefits because the hunter will market Cassie's knowledge of hunting as well as her creativity to capture the "perfect" hunt using gold and an ivory tooth.

The sport of hunting and the beauty of jewelry come together in a unique piece of jewelry that will truly stand the test of time. The sentimental value of the piece will always outweigh the actual value of the piece and that is why Cassie is so attracted to this market. The opportunity to make jewelry and talk about hunting in her own place of business has always been a dream and she will strive to achieve this dream with success.

SECTION I BUSINESS DESCRIPTION

BUSINESS CONCEPT

Custom Jewelry Design by Cassie Leyh is a new style of retail jewelry to fit everyone's needs. With Cassie's Certified expertise in jewelry design and a retail storefront we are able to customize everyone's dreams into silver, gold, or platinum. In addition to our extensive custom work we will also offer jewelry repair, appraisals, loose stones as well as a wide selection of manufactured jewelry.

BUSINESS NAME

We named the business Custom Jewelry Design by Cassie Leyh because it is easy to say and easy to locate it the phone book. Also with the use of the owners name our customers are able to research Cassie's expertise in the field of jewelry design. We have registered this name with the Department of Revenue with the form CR 100 (See Appendix A).

GOALS

The goals of Custom Jewelry Design by Cassie Leyh are to please our customers with the highest quality of fine jewelry. It has been Cassie's dream to take the talent of jewelry making and make a profit with a skill that she has always loved. It is a dream to her to customize jewelry and have a store to call her own. This gives her the freedom of customizing jewelry as well as her lifestyle. Cassie has grown up working in her family business and was raised with entrepreneurial family motifs. Seeing how her family has succeeded with small business ownership has encouraged her to follow in the footsteps and start her dreams too. Custom Jewelry Design by Cassie Leyh will achieve a good profit by completing at least 50 custom designed pieces a year.

INDUSTRY ANALYSIS

The retail jewelry industry is growing more rapidly as the years go by. In 20xx the jewelry store sales in the United States was \$14,180,000,000 dollars and has been increased to \$17,555,000,000 in 20xx (<http://mjasa.polygon.net>). The product life cycle is in the growth stage and we plan to join right in with our business idea and new technology in the custom jewelry design. To enter this market one needs to have expertise in jewelry design and the skill to back up their designs. It is also essential that one be certified to grade and appraise the stones that they set and appraise the retail value of the pieces they create. The Gemological Institute of America is one of the most respected and recognized Institutes in the United States. With Cassie's certification from G.I.A. she will be recognized as one of their approved appraisers. In Grand Junction Colorado there is no other jeweler that has this certification and that will be a good way to gain customers and trust.

FORM OF BUSINESS

The form of ownership that we are planning is the sole proprietorship. The benefit to this form of ownership is you are your own boss with full decision making responsibilities and with Cassie's expertise this is a good way to excel in the industry. There are minimal legal requirements to start a sole proprietor business and this makes it easier and less expensive to start the business. Another benefit to this form of ownership is that the owner receives all of the profits and is only taxed once.

FACILITY REQUIREMENTS

The location of Custom Jewelry Design by Cassie Leyh will be in the downtown area of Grand Junction Colorado. The storefront will be approximately one thousand square feet. The average rent in this area is seven dollars a square foot. The rent would be approximately six hundred dollars a month and seven thousand dollars a year. We will need to equip the storefront with locked display cases and a cash register. There will need to be a complete jewelers bench and office. We will also need to install a computer system to keep track of inventory, accounting, and run our jewelry design program.

The sign will be neat and simple yet eye catching. The sign will be a twirling diamond in white neon with Custom Jewelry Design by Cassie Leyh in fancy purple neon writing. Under the neon will be a marquise to market sales and specials. The cost of this sign is approximately eight thousand dollars.

OPENING DATE

Custom Jewelry Design by Cassie Leyh will open on October 1, 20xx because it will give us enough time to get custom orders and complete them in time for the hunting season and holidays. This will give us time to promote our new concept in jewelry design to be profitable.

LEGAL REQUIREMENTS

- Sales and Use tax license
- Quarterly income tax estimates
- Individual Income Tax
- Contract Agreement
- Lease Agreement
- Name Registration
- Property Taxes
- Liability Issues
- Insurance/• Unemployment Insurance
- Workman's Compensation
- Hiring Policy
- Payroll Taxes
- Firing and Termination Policy

SECTION II MARKETING PLAN

GEOGRAPHIC MARKET

The Geographic market of Custom Jewelry Design by Cassie Leyh is Grand Junction, Colorado and surrounding areas.

CUSTOMER PROFILE

Custom Jewelry Design by Cassie Leyh will primarily target those customers needing customized quality jewelry. Our target market will be geared toward elk hunters that want to display their trophy ivory teeth in superb, unique custom jewelry. This market will include successful residents as well as successful out of state hunters. This style of jewelry is becoming more popular as the hunting industry is expanding. The excitement, skill and thrill of taking a bull elk can be displayed in attractive custom jewelry. Vicki at Junction Gems has prospered on the hunters that come back every year to acquire her unique designs around elk ivory. She considers hunters to be one of her largest customer types to take advantage of her unique jewelry design talent.

POTENTIAL CUSTOMERS

The amount of potential customers will vary depending on the level of success in elk hunting in Mesa County. According to Vicki she creates an average of 100 custom elk ivory pieces a year. I have hope of capturing at least 50 custom elk ivory pieces a year until I acquire a strong customer base.

MARKET PENETRATION

My penetration goal for the first year in business will be to capture 50% of the elk ivory target market. I feel that this is a reasonable estimate because the advertising emphasis on the hunter and the demand for the style will bring back customers and their friends for years to come just as Junction Gems has experienced.

COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

The major competitors in the custom jewelry business in the grand valley are Thomas Hunn Co., Page Parsons Jewelry, and Junction Gems. Their strengths and weaknesses are represented in the following tables.

Thomas Hunn Co Inc.

STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
1. Established clientele 2. Reputable name for custom work. 3. Experience in the industry 4. Unique designs 5. Access to quality wholesalers 6. Certified Gemologist	1. Retirement 2. Location 3. Diversity in the market. 4. New trends in jewelry 5. Overpriced on merchandise

Page Parson's Jewelers

STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
1. Over 30 designer jewelry lines 2. Established since 1895 3. Advertising exposure 4. Trusted Name 5. Location 6. Certified Gemologist	1. Limited parking 2. Changes in Management 3. High overhead 4. Overpriced products 5. Limited target market

Junction Gems

STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
1. Diverse Products 2. Established clientele 3. Excellent custom designs 4. In store repairs 5. Years of experience in design	1. Location 2. Recent death in ownership 3. Sole-proprietor 4. Burnt out 5. Advertising

Custom Jewelry Design by Cassie Leyh

STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
1. Certified Jeweler Gemologist from the Gemological Institute of America. 2. Good downtown location with lots of parking 3. Low overhead 4. Lower prices 5. Excited about the industry	1. New business 2. Lack of established customers 3. Experience in the industry 4. Limited Capital

PRICING

Based on the competitive analysis Custom Jewelry Design by Cassie Leyh will use the Market Penetration philosophy to price the inventory. The strategy behind this philosophy is to have a lower price to get the customers in the door. Once the customers are established and the business in the growth stage, the business can increase prices. The jewelry industry's markup on products can be from 300%-600% depending on the demand. With low costs I will be able to sell at a lower price and still make a profit even if it is just 200%. Once established customers will be willing to pay more for quality and expertise they can trust.

PROMOTION

Custom Jewelry Design by Cassie Leyh will promote the grand opening by advertising on local radio stations one month prior to opening. On the grand opening day KEKB will broadcast live from the location and give promotional items. Other advertising will include a quarter page in the yellow pages, a quarter page print add in the Dailey Sentinel (See Appendix B), an add in the Colorado Division of Wildlife proclamation for big game seasons in Colorado, and a few catchy commercial adds.

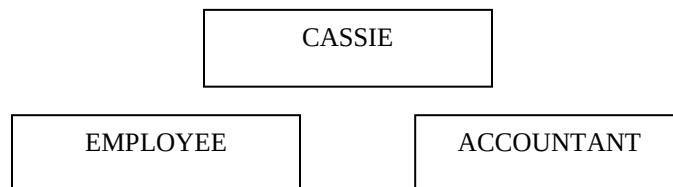
SECTION III MANAGEMENT PLAN

EMPLOYEES

Custom Jewelry Design by Cassie Leyh will mostly be run by Cassie, she will do the bookkeeping (reconcile cash on hand, inventory control, etc.) as well as create custom jewelry. Cassie will require the following employees. A retail salesperson to show jewelry to potential customers, collect payments and have an extensive knowledge of the jewelry industry to communicate to customers. Daily tasks will include showing jewelry, cash register skills, and customer relations. Cassie also plans to hire an accountant to produce all of the external financial reporting necessary.

ORGANIZATIONAL CHART

There isn't much of an organizational chart but all employees will report to Cassie for every final decision related to the business.



BUSINESS EXPERIENCE

Cassie Leyh has grown up in an entrepreneurial family. It has always been a dream of Cassie's to own her own business. Cassie has a Bachelor degree in Business Administration with a concentration in Management. She is also a Graduate Jeweler Gemologist under the Gemological Institute of America and with this expertise she is able to grade and appraise diamonds, colored stones, pearls, and just about any form of jewelry. Cassie has worked in the jewelry industry for 6 years and has followed the growth potential for custom jewelry. With experience in the industry and the creativity and skill acquired at G.I.A. Cassie plans to make this business into a prosperous one for many years to come. (See Resume in Appendix C)

Cassie Leyh CV

2665 G ½ Rd. Grand Junction, Co 81506

Skills and Capabilities

- Able to create custom jewelry in silver, gold and platinum
- Extensive experience in designing jewelry
- Able to appraise diamonds, colored stones, pearls, and just about any type of jewelry
- Able to budget time, perform under stress, adapt to challenges and follow through on projects
- Excellent communication skills
- Good Bookkeeping skills
- Established knowledge of computers

Experience

Jeweler Apprentice

- Learned essential jeweler tasks involving design, casting, stone setting, and finishing quality jewelry.

Sales Manager

- Helped customers select a variety of jewelry and extend knowledge to customers.
- Acquired Bookkeeping skills

Education **Mesa State College, Grand Junction, Co 81501**
Degree: Bachelor in Business Administration with
concentration in Management
GPA in major: 3.6 (4.0=A)

Gemological Institute Of America
Graduate Jeweler Gemologist w/wax and design

References Joe Smith, Investment Banker
Wells Fargo Bank, Grand Junction Co.

Amy Keele, Owner of Amy's Custom Jewelry
Carlsbad, CA (442) 555-5555

Bob Black, Professor of Gemology
Gemological Institute of America (442) 555-5555